

Standard Operating Procedure

Imaging QA: Appropriateness Screening and Peer Review

«Hospital Name» — Supports AAC.9.b, AAC.9.c

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» screens imaging orders for clinical appropriateness before the examination, and reviews a sample of completed studies for reporting quality.

2. Scope

Applies to every imaging order before it is scheduled, and to a defined sample of CT and MRI studies after reporting.

3. Responsibility

Imaging Staff / Radiologist: screens orders for appropriateness and queries the requesting doctor if the order does not match best-practice guidelines.

Peer Reviewer (another radiologist): reviews the defined sample of studies and grades any discrepancy.

4. Procedure

4.1 Appropriateness screening

1. Before scheduling, check every imaging order against current best-practice guidelines for that clinical indication. The ACR Appropriateness Criteria — see Section 8, Reference 1 — is a recognised, evidence-based source for this screening.

2. If the order does not appear appropriate, consult the requesting doctor before proceeding, and document the consultation and outcome.

4.2 Peer review

1. Review a defined sample of CT and MRI studies — at minimum one percent — per the schedule and periodicity the hospital has defined for each modality. The ACR's RADPEER programme — see Section 8, Reference 2 — is a recognised structure for this kind of peer review and discrepancy scoring.

2. Grade any discrepancy found by severity, and log it in the Peer Review Record.

3. Discuss significant discrepancies at a discrepancy meeting where held, and capture learning points.

5. Records

Supported by Records 3–6 of the AAC.9 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_AAC_9_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — AAC.9 policy

7. Review

Reviewed annually.

8. References

- American College of Radiology. (n.d.). ACR Appropriateness Criteria. <https://www.acr.org/Clinical-Resources/Clinical-Tools-and-Reference/Appropriateness-Criteria>
- American College of Radiology. (n.d.). RADPEER peer review program. <https://www.acr.org/Clinical-Resources/Clinical-Tools-and-Reference/RADPEER>